

Appendix: Ethics Audit – Alignment with 2026 Standards

This appendix demonstrates how the Mercy Shards process aligns with key ethical AI data standards as of 2026, including dynamic consent, provenance integrity, human-centric invention, algorithmic explainability, and security against re-identification. The process is designed to prioritize speaker dignity, voluntary participation, and long-term human benefit over extraction or control.

1. Dynamic Consent (Ongoing & Revocable)

- Consent is **explicit, voluntary, and revocable at any time** (Section 3.2).
- Revocation process: Speaker emails steward → private files deleted from offline drive → public registry index updated to note revocation. NFT receipt remains as historical proof of original intent.
- No one-time checkbox; speaker retains control even after permanence (metadata tag “revoked” can be added in future logic layers).

2. Provenance Integrity (Immutable Lineage & Human Proof)

- Full lineage tracked: original raw file → edited clip → hashes → Arweave upload.
- Dual SHA-256 hashes (raw original + edited clip) + timestamps + device metadata prove authenticity without revealing content.
- Arweave ANS tagging applied to all uploads (e.g., “mercy-shard”, “human-signal”, “2026”).
- Offline originals never leave steward’s drive — only hashes are public, allowing verification without exposure.

3. Human-Centric Invention

- AI role is auxiliary only (local Whisper for transcription/timestamp suggestion, human override required — Section 3.3).
- Moral framework, virtue prioritization (mercy/humility as crown virtues), consent logic, and stewardship vision originate from the human architect.
- Process explicitly documented as human-led (Section 1 & 5).

4. Algorithmic Explainability

- Editing is human-performed with transparent steps (listen once → identify strongest fragment → trim → human override).
- Optional AI assistance uses clear, quoted prompt (Section 3.3) — suggestions only, no final decisions.
- Virtue scoring (1–10) based on authenticity, emotional arc, virtue match — all human-judged.

5. Security Against Re-identification

- Raw originals never public (offline drive only).
- Anonymity option available (no name/contact required).
- Edited clips can have names/locations stripped if requested.
- Speaker owns wallet key (JSON file offline) — controls vault access.
- Audit possible via hashes + micro-ping context (1 min before/after) without exposing content.

This process meets or exceeds current 2026 ethical standards for human moral data preservation. It is humble, open to refinement, and built to prioritize speaker dignity and future benefit over extraction or control.

[End of Appendix – Ethics Audit]